

Electronics can really be a game changer for social causes in the coming years



Pratul Shroff, CEO, eInfochips, wants to apply technology in a multitude of ways to bridge India's developmental gap of several hundred years in a matter of decade. He encourages the thought of highly specialised, very-low-cost electronic applications for rural education, healthcare, employment and upliftment. He hopes that electronics can play a big role in pulling masses out of poverty. As an example, a portable, handheld authentication device can ensure that social benefits go to the real need—especially in light of the Unique Identity (UID) project. This can reduce leakage, transfer the benefits to the truly deserved and accelerate the pace of poverty reduction. Electronics can really be a game changer for social causes in the coming years.

"On the global front, as India emerges as a growth-oriented economy that is going to triple its economic output in the next decade, its share of electronics in almost all sectors is going to grow significantly. The challenge for India to become a global electronics player is two-fold," opines Shroff.

"Till date, most of the electronics products are designed outside India keeping in mind the needs of global markets. Once design is done, manufacturing is done mostly in China. This mass production is also meant for global consumption. Therefore India has to figure out how to master electronics manufacturing—just like automotive sector. Here, the government can definitely play a proactive and positive role in attracting investment and talent," adds Shroff.

We need favorable policy for 'Made in India' brands



Sanjeev Sehgal, managing director, Sparsh Security, stresses on the need for a favourable policy to promote local companies. According to him, the government policy does not adequately promote 'Made in India' brands. It is difficult to obtain funds to invest in R&D and manufacturing. Lack of consistent and favourable business policy, lack of adequate trained manpower and lack of resources to promote Indian brands are the key points of his concern.

Sehgal expects a pro-business policy in the budget that encourages investment in design and development of electronic products in India by local companies to serve the needs of Indian markets. The government may either make available a pool of funds to encourage local R&D and build local brands or provide tax benefits for companies investing in local R&D and increasing local employment.

Finally, he recommends that electronic security products be brought under the category of 'basic needs' and VAT be brought down to 4 per cent instead of 12.5 per cent.

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